

Silver Linden

Tilia tomentosa



Origin

Native to southeastern Europe and western Asia, valued as a street tree partly because it tolerates heat, drought, and urban pollution better than other lindens.

Look for

Every leaf has a felted, silvery-white underside caused by dense microscopic hairs -- flip one over on a still day to see the contrast against the dark green top.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Leaf underside: felted, silvery-white from dense microscopic hairs (trichomes).
- Leaf shape: heart-shaped, similar to other lindens.
- Bloom timing: later in summer than other city lindens.
- Commonly confused with: silver maple (silver linden's leaf is heart-shaped, not lobed, and its underside is felted rather than smooth and waxy).

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Heart-shaped leaves unfold with silvery-white undersides visible from the start.
Summer	Fragrant flowers bloom slightly later in summer than other lindens.
Fall	Leaves turn yellow.
Winter	Smooth gray bark and rounded crown are visible on bare branches.

DID YOU KNOW

- It tends to bloom later in the summer than other linden species, extending the nectar season for city bees.
- Its silvery undersides make the whole canopy shimmer distinctly in wind, a trait beekeepers and gardeners have prized it for since it was first introduced to Western Europe in the 1700s.